TA studio brief — Refining technique through structured critique

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

TA practical setup & focus

Provide 6 cm x 6 cm heavy cartridge swatch squares on every table and model how to test a translucent glaze and opaque highlight before touching the main piece.

Studio kit: Developing identity artworks, Week 1-3 portfolio sheets, A3 heavy cartridge/mount boards, full wet/dry studio media, swatch cards, critique matrices

Key words to prompt

• criteria-led critique: Evaluating an artwork against specific technical benchmarks rather than personal opinion.

• high-leverage: A focused change to a key area (like the focal contour or core shadow) that lifts the whole artwork.

• value contrast: The visual punch created by placing your darkest dark next to your brightest light.

• resolution: Bringing all parts of an artwork to a purposeful, cohesive finish.

• synthesis: Combining insights from skill trials, practitioner analysis, and critique into the final piece.

Supported route steps

1. Check your identity artwork against the four studio criteria on your card and tick your top refinement target.

2. Test your chosen tool (thick brush contour, shadow glaze, or bright highlight) on the 6 cm swatch box.

3. Apply the refinement carefully to resolve your main identity artwork.

4. Complete the 'Before -> Swatch -> After' sentences on your critique sheet.

Check: Criteria checked, swatch tested, final identity piece resolved, and critique sheet completed.

Review & exit support

Exit question: What is the quickest studio method to quieten a busy patterned background that is competing with your central focal point?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to facilitate a four-criteria peer critique and live swatch verification.